

THE STUDY • A FINDING FROM PSYCHIATRY RESEARCH

Can meditation help students cope with stress? A survey of undergraduates during India's COVID-19 lockdown



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77%

OF SOS MEDITATORS

vs.

40%

OF NON-MEDITATORS

said their mental and emotional well-being
held steady through India's COVID lockdown.



WHO

College students in Delhi

148 undergrads aged 18–26 surveyed during India's nationwide COVID lockdown, April–June 2020.



WHAT

A simple daily practice

SOS meditation: sit quietly, eyes closed, attention focused inward while silently repeating a calming word.



WE FOUND

Steadier minds, less stress

Meditators were nearly twice as likely to say lockdown didn't shake their well-being—and reported lower stress.



WHY IT MATTERS

A tool anyone can use

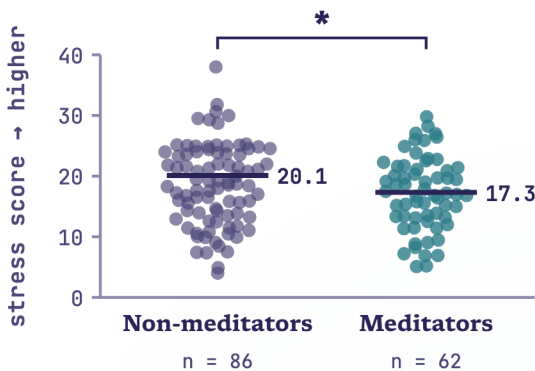
Meditation is free, portable, and culturally familiar. The more often students practiced, the lower their stress.

HOW WE MEASURED IT

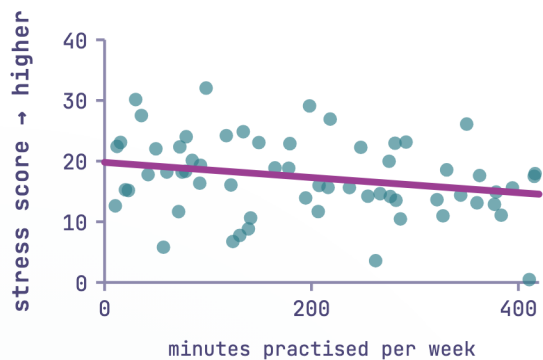
A standard stress questionnaire, scored 0–40

Participants took the Perceived Stress Scale (PSS-10), a widely-used self-report measuring how often everyday demands felt unmanageable in the past month. Lower scores mean lower stress.

A Meditators less stressed vs. everyone else



B SOS meditators: more meditation (min/wk) lead to lesser stress



SOS Meditators reported less stress, and more practice tracked with lesser stress still.

HOW TO READ THIS

Cross-sectional comparison, not a randomized trial; meditators self-selected. Findings are associations, not proof of cause. Sample: Indian undergraduates 18–26 during the 2020 lockdown.

CITATION

Munjal P, Khurana N, Saggar M, Kumar L (2025). The role of meditation in coping with stress during the COVID-19 lockdown: a cross-sectional study of undergraduates in India. *Frontiers in Psychiatry* 16:1573407.



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